SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #32 · TRUTH

“Truth is whatever feels right to me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A culture that says “follow your heart” and “live your truth.” Hurt from rigid rules that made you distrust any outside authority. Wanting to avoid conflict by letting everyone decide for themselves. Times when your feelings did guide you well. Not having been taught that truth is something we discover, not something we create.

What Scripture teaches

Our feelings are real and important, but they are not reliable judges of truth. Scripture warns that there is a way that seems right to a person, but it ends in death, and that the human heart can deceive us. Jesus said God’s Word is truth, and that if we continue in His word, we will know the truth and the truth will set us free. Truth is found in God, not invented by our feelings.

> *“There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death”* **(Proverbs 14:12)**.

Also see

> “The heart is deceitful above all things and beyond cure. Who can understand it?” **(Jeremiah 17:9)**.

> “Sanctify them by the truth; Your word is truth” **(John 17:17)**.

> “So He said to the Jews who had believed Him, ‘If you continue in My word, you are truly My disciples. Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.’” **(John 8:31–32)**.

> “Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path” **(Psalm 119:105)**.

Common self-statements

- If it feels right, it must be right.
- My truth is just as valid as anyone else’s.
- No one can tell me what’s true for me.
- If I feel peace about it, God must approve.
- Rules are just other people’s opinions.
- I’ll know the truth by how it feels.

Common logical errors

- **Emotional reasoning:** Deciding what is true based on how something feels.
- **Relativism:** Treating truth as personal preference instead of reality.
- **Selective attention:** Remembering when feelings were right and forgetting when they misled you.
- **Overconfidence:** Trusting your heart more than God’s Word.

Challenging questions

- Have my feelings ever been wrong about something important?
- What does Proverbs 14:12 say about a way that seems right?

- If truth is just a feeling, how could anyone ever be wrong?
- Where does Jesus say truth is found?
- Do I want my doctor or my bank to work by feelings?
- Is this belief protecting me from something I don't want to face?
- What would it look like to let God's Word guide my feelings?

Truth summary

> Truth is not whatever feels right to me. My feelings matter, but they can be mistaken. God's Word is truth, and it is a lamp to my feet. When I continue in Jesus' word, I will know the truth, and the truth will set me free. I can bring my feelings under the light of His Word.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- **Truth**
- **Scripture/Word**
- **Thinking, Healthy**
- **Wisdom**
- **Guidance**

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Truth is whatever feels right to me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Truth is whatever feels right to me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Have my feelings ever been wrong about something important?
- ☐ What happens to the way that seems right?
- ☐ If truth is a feeling, can anyone be wrong?
- ☐ Where does Jesus say truth is found?
- ☐ Would I want my doctor to work by feelings?
- ☐ How can God's Word guide my feelings?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's Word is truth.
- ☐ My feelings matter, but they are not the final judge.
- ☐ The truth will set me free.
- ☐ God's Word is a lamp to my feet.
- ☐ I can bring my feelings under the light of Scripture.
- ☐ Truth is something I discover, not something I create.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Proverbs 14:12**
  "There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death."
- [ ] **Jeremiah 17:9**
  "The heart is deceitful above all things and beyond cure. Who can understand it?"
- [ ] **John 17:17**
  "Sanctify them by the truth; Your word is truth."
- [ ] **John 8:31–32**
  "So He said to the Jews who had believed Him, 'If you continue in My word, you are truly My disciples. Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.'"
- [ ] **Psalm 119:105**
  "Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path."

A verse I found myself: _____

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Feelings and facts log:** When a strong feeling tells me something is true, write the feeling, then write what Scripture and the facts say.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 119:105 becomes: "Your word is a lamp to **Sarah's** feet and a light to **her** path."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Truth" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio download.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write down a time a strong feeling led you wrong,** and what you learned from it.
- ☐ **Before your next decision, ask:** "What do I feel? What does God's Word say? What do wise people say?" Write all three.
- ☐ **Read John 8:31–36,** and write what Jesus says about truth and freedom.
- ☐ **Memorize John 17:17** and say it whenever you are tempted to trust a feeling over God's Word.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Truth is whatever feels right to me": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One feeling I checked against Scripture
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Truth is whatever feels right to me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, thank You that Your Word is truth. Help me reject the lie that truth is whatever feels right to me. Teach me to value my feelings without letting them rule me, and to let Your Word be a lamp to my feet. Lead me into the truth that sets me free. In Jesus' name, Amen.

✦ ✦ ✦

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.